

Table tennis needs a champion like Achanta Sharath Kamal

Achanta Sharath Kamal **wrapped up** his career this week 20 years after winning the Arjuna Award, and having **raised the bar** for what a TT player could achieve on the professional circuit. He was 40 when he won his 7th Commonwealth Games gold, and that was a **testament to** his love for a sport that he continued to promote by staying competitive for three **decades**. No one will **grudge** him the “Thala of TT” **moniker**, such was his dedication despite the sport’s limited popularity. His two **bronzes** at Asian Games in 2018 **had** pushed other Indian players to **aspire** for more.

Sharath never **rested on** his **laurels**, and used every possible technological innovation to **polish** his game. He almost **volunteered** to allow the Chinese to videotape and **dissect** him, **in order to** stay at their training base and learn TT hacks. **Countless** winters were spent **plying his trade** in European leagues, even if Indians noticed his presence only during the multi-disciplinary Games. But Sharath would help several Indian juniors **step up** at the Games and **shepherd** them through nervous times at the table.



Going ahead, Sharath Kamal has earned his **cred** as an experienced professional **in tune with** the requirements of the modern game reaching the highest ranking of 30. He continued **in the footsteps of** past players Chetan Baboor and S Raman, **going well past** their medal counts. His 13 CWG **medals**, including the men’s singles golds 16 years apart (2006 and 2022), **will** remain an **astonishing** record in Indian sport. Never **cribbing**, **hardly** ever demanding more than TT was assigned, Sharath remained uncontroversial and **dignified**. Now that he looks bound towards the game’s administration, he would be expected to ensure that table tennis aims even higher than that which he **accomplished** quietly. TT needs a Pullela Gopichand to push it into the next **orbit** and Sharath could be the one to do so.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where ‘red’ denotes ‘subject’ and ‘blue’ denotes ‘verb’.

[Practice Exercise]

Vocabulary

1. **Wrap up** (phrasal verb) – Conclude, Finish, Complete, End, Terminate समाप्त करना
2. **Raise the bar** (phrase) – Set higher standards, Elevate expectations, Improve quality, Enhance performance मानक ऊँचा करना
3. **Testament** (to) – (noun) – Proof, Evidence, Testament, Demonstration, Confirmation प्रमाण
4. **Decade** (noun) – Ten years, Decennium, Tenyear period दशक
5. **Grudge** (verb) – Resent, Begrudge, Envy, Dislike, Harbor resentment बुरा मानना
6. **Moniker** (noun) – Nickname, Title, Name, Label, Tag उपनाम
7. **Aspire** (verb) – Strive, Aim, Hope, Desire, Long आकांक्षा रखना
8. **Rest** (on) – (verb) – Depend, Rely, Base, Hinge, Count निर्भर करना
9. **Laurel** (noun) – Honor, Award, Accolade, Prize, Recognition सम्मान
10. **Polish** (verb) – Refine, Improve, Perfect, Hone, Enhance निखारना
11. **Volunteer** (verb) – Offer, Propose, Present, Step forward, Come forward स्वेच्छा से करना
12. **Dissect** (verb) – Analyze, Examine, Study, Scrutinize, Break down विश्लेषण करना
13. **In order to** (phrase) – So as to, With the aim of, For the purpose of, To के लिए
14. **Countless** (adjective) – Numerous, Innumerable, Infinite, Many, Endless असंख्य
15. **Ply one's trade** (phrase) – Practice, Work, Perform, Exercise, Engage अपना काम करना
16. **Step up** (phrasal verb) – Improve, Increase, Advance, Progress, Enhance सुधारना
17. **Shepherd** (verb) – Guide, Lead, Direct, Mentor, Escort मार्गदर्शन करना
18. **Going ahead** (phrase) – In the future, Moving forward, From now on, Hereafter आगे बढ़ते हुए
19. **Cred** (noun) – Credibility, Reputation, Standing, Status, Esteem प्रतिष्ठा
20. **In tune with** (phrase) – Aligned with, Compatible with, Consistent with, Harmonized with के अनुरूप
21. **In the footsteps of someone** (phrase) – Follow, Emulate, Imitate, Copy, Mirror किसी के नक्शेकदम पर चलना

22. **Go past something** (phrase) – Exceed, Surpass, Outdo, Transcend, Outstrip पार करना

23. **Astonishing** (adjective) – Amazing, Astounding, Stunning, Surprising, Remarkable आश्चर्यजनक

24. **Crib** (verb) – Complain, Moan, Whine, Grumble, Grouse शिकायत करना

25. **Hardly** (adverb) – Barely, Scarcely, Rarely, Seldom, Almost not मुश्किल से

26. **Dignify** (verb) – Honor, Respect, Esteem, Grace, Elevate सम्मानित करना

27. **Accomplish** (verb) – Achieve, Attain, Complete, Fulfill, Realize पूरा करना

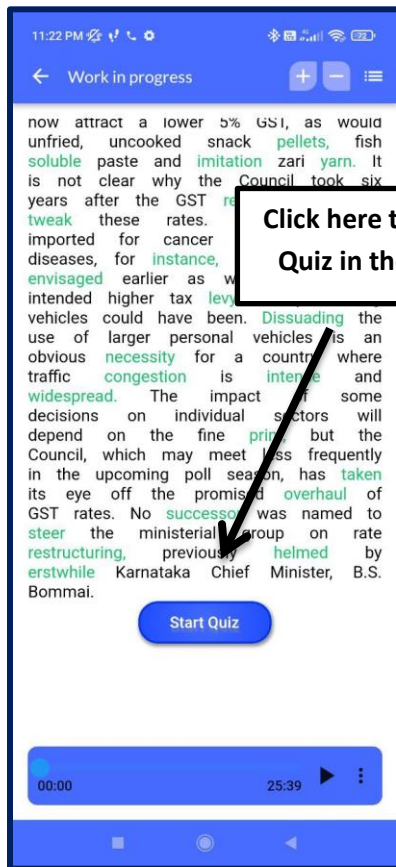
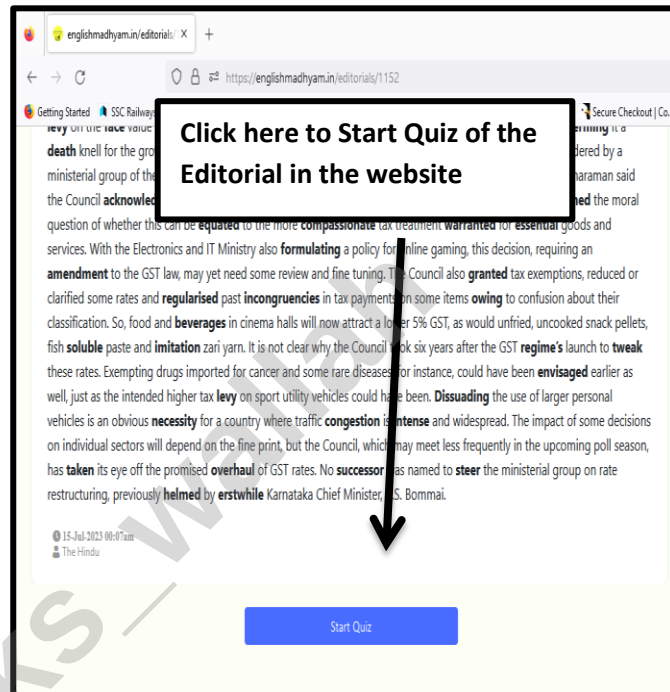
28. **Orbit** (noun) – Sphere, Domain, Realm, Circle, Arena क्षेत्र

@mocks_wallah

Summary of the Editorial

1. **Legendary Career** – Achanta Sharath Kamal concluded his 20-year career after raising the bar for Indian table tennis.
2. **Arjuna Awardee** – He won the Arjuna Award and remained a dominant force in the sport for decades.
3. **Age-Defying Success** – At 40, he won his 7th Commonwealth Games (CWG) gold, showcasing his enduring passion.
4. **Inspiration for Others** – His two Asian Games bronzes (2018) motivated younger Indian players to aim higher.
5. **Technological Adaptation** – He embraced innovations and even allowed Chinese coaches to study his game to improve.
6. **European Experience** – Played in European leagues for years, gaining exposure despite limited recognition in India.
7. **Mentorship** – Guided young Indian players, helping them handle pressure in major tournaments.
8. **Highest Ranking** – Achieved a career-high world ranking of 30, proving his elite status.
9. **Surpassing Predecessors** – Outperformed past legends like Chetan Baboor and S. Raman in medal count.
10. **Record CWG Haul** – Won 13 CWG medals, including singles golds 16 years apart (2006 & 2022).
11. **Consistent Excellence** – Maintained a dignified, controversy-free career without excessive demands.
12. **Future in Administration** – Expected to transition into sports administration to elevate Indian TT further.
13. **Need for a TT Gopichand** – Table tennis requires a visionary like Pullela Gopichand to reach the next level.
14. **Sharath's Potential Role** – He could be the leader to drive systemic growth in Indian table tennis.
15. **"Thala of TT" Legacy** – Earned immense respect for his dedication in a less popular sport, leaving a lasting impact.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based

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